

PUBLIC

AI Index: AMR 23/025/2001

28 February 2001

Further information on UA 30/01 (AMR 23/009/2001, 2 February 2001) and follow up (AMR 23/021/2001, 19 February 2001) - Fear for Safety

**COLOMBIA Internally displaced people at the La Nohora and La Reliquia camps  
in the city of Villavicencio, Meta Department**

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Representatives of the internally displaced people sheltering in two camps in Villavicencio are still being intimidated. Amnesty International continues to be concerned for the safety of all those at the camps.

Members of the police *Servicio de Investigaciones Judiciales e Inteligencia*, (SIJIN), Judicial Investigation and Intelligence Service, and military intelligence (B2) have reportedly been pressuring leaders of the displaced community at La Nohora camp to reveal the identity of those who denounced army intimidation of the displaced community to the international community.

The harassment is of particular concern since it is continuing even though President Andrés Pastrana has made a commitment to guarantee the safe relocation of the displaced people. In a letter to Amnesty International, dated 12 February 2001, he stated that: "the resettlement process of the 150 families ... will be carried out after agreement is reached between the Governorship of Meta and the representatives of the displaced people themselves... Any change of location will be only to ensure a resettlement to an area or areas which provide the same or better conditions than the ones in which the displaced are currently living" ("*el proceso de reubicación de las 150 familias ... se adelantará de común acuerdo entre la Gobernación del Meta y los representantes de los mismos desplazados ... . Cualquier cambio de lugar será únicamente para reubicarlos en otro u otros que proporcionen las mismas o mejores condiciones que las que tienen ahora*").

**FURTHER RECOMMENDED ACTION: Please send telegrams/telexes/faxes/express/airmail letters in Spanish or in your own language:**

- expressing concern at the continued intimidation of the displaced people of the La Nohora camp and concern for the safety of the community's leaders;
- urging President Andrés Pastrana to take immediate steps to end the harassment against the displaced community;
- urging that all measures deemed appropriate by those under threat are taken to guarantee their safety;
- urging the Colombian Government to guarantee the safety of the displaced people sheltering at the La Nohora and La Reliquia camps, and to ensure that they are not forcibly evicted, in line with commitments made by President Pastrana;
- continuing to express concern that over a thousand soldiers are reportedly waiting to evict those sheltering at the La Nohora camp.

**APPEALS TO:**

President of the Republic  
Señor Presidente Andrés Pastrana Arango  
Presidente de la República  
Palacio de Nariño  
Carrera 8 No.7-26  
Santafé de Bogotá, COLOMBIA  
**Fax: + 57 1 336 2109 / 337 1351**

**Salutation: Dear President / Excmo. Sr. Presidente**

Minister of Interior

Señor Armando Estrada Villa

Ministro del Interior, Ministerio del Interior, Palacio Echeverry

Carrera 8a, No.8-09, piso 2o., Santafé de Bogotá, Colombia

**Telegrams:Ministro Interior, Bogota, Colombia**

**Fax: + 57 1 341 9583 / 334 3960**

**Salutation:Dear Sir / Sr. Ministro**

Governor of Meta Department

Alan Jara Urzola

Gobernación de Meta

Carrera 33 N°38-45

Villavicencio, Meta, Colombia

**Salutation:Dear Governor / Sr. Gobernador**

**COPIES TO:**

National Advocate for the People

Sr. Eduardo Cifuentes

Defensor del Pueblo, Defensoría del Pueblo

Calle 55, No. 10-32/46, Santafé de Bogotá, Colombia

UN High Commissioner for Refugees

Alto Comisionado de las Naciones Unidas para Refugiados (ACNUR)

Calle 114 No.9-01 Edificio Teleport Torre A Oficina 601

Santafé de Bogotá, Colombia

and to diplomatic representatives of< accredited to your country.

**PLEASE SEND APPEALS IMMEDIATELY.** Check with the International Secretariat, or your section office, if sending appeals after 11 April 2001.